

GIBSON CUSTOM SHOP • MADE-2-MEASURE

Les Paul Custom Figured

“Dark Blue Widow Burst” — 2024

SERIALCS 403228

ORIGINNashville Custom Shop

CONDITIONNear-Mint / Complete

INCLUDES

OHSC • COA • Tags

NEW / STREET	REVERB - RECENT SOLD	PRIVATE / LOCAL SALE	SHOP / DEALER OFFER
\$6,999–7,099	\$7,199	\$4,800–5,500	\$3,800–4,800
Current dealer retail for this run	*24 sibling, mint, sold via dealer	Denver marketplace, realistic net	Cash; more in trade / store credit

01 What it is

MODEL	Gibson Custom Shop Les Paul Custom Figured — “Dark Blue Widow Burst”
YEAR	2024 (decoded from serial)
SERIAL	CS 403228 = CS (Custom Shop) + 4 (2024) + 03228 (build no.)
BUILD TYPE	Made-2-Measure / dealer-exclusive limited run — not a catalog production model
FAMILY	“Widow” series — defined by colour-matched binding & coloured split-diamond headstock inlay



PLATE 04 - FULL FACE: AAA FIGURED MAPLE TOP, BLUE-MATCHED 7-PLY BINDING, GOLD HARDWARE.

The certificate, the “Gibson Custom” stamp on the back of the headstock, and the oval “Gibson Custom” plate on the rear of the body confirm this is a genuine Nashville Custom Shop instrument — a meaningfully higher tier than a regular Gibson USA Les Paul Custom. The serial decodes cleanly on the modern Custom Shop pattern (CS + year-digit + build number), placing the build in 2024.

The “Widow” tag is the key to the finish. What separates a Blue Widow from an ordinary blue Les Paul Custom is the colour-matched treatment: the blue-tinted split-diamond headstock inlay, blue binding wrapping the body, neck and headstock, and the trans-blue burst over a hand-picked figured maple cap. Gibson has run the Widow theme in blue, red, purple, orange and green over the years — all low-volume Custom Shop pieces sold through select dealers, which is why you rarely see them on a big-box wall.

02 The evidence

PLATE 01 - TOP

Carved Face - Flame figure, gold covered humbuckers, gold TOM & stopbar, Rhythmic/Treble poker chip.

PLATE 02 - HEADSTOCK

Blue split-diamond inlay, gold Grover kidney tuners, “Les Paul Custom” rod cover.

PLATE 03 - FINGERBOARD

Ebony board with pearl block inlays, multi-ply binding — full Custom appointments.

PLATE 04 - FULL FRONT

Single-cut LP Custom silhouette, blue-matched binding head to tail.

PLATE 05 - NECK REAR

Gloss blue neck; “Gibson Custom” headstock stamp — inspect here for repairs.

PLATE 06 - BODY REAR

Oval “Gibson Custom” plate & control cavity cover — check for buckle rash.

PLATE 07 - IN CASE

Original brown/gold-plush Custom hardshell case — present & correct.

PLATE 08 - PAPERS

Gibson Custom Certificate of Authenticity — “Les Paul Custom”, CS403228.

03 Specification

Based on the matching Widow-series spec sheets. Two items are worth confirming in person — flagged below — because they swing value and have varied between runs.

BODY	Mahogany back, 2-pc hand-picked AAA figured maple top	PICKUPS ▶	490R / 498T humbuckers, gold covers (confirm — some runs shipped Custombuckers or EMG)
FINISH	Dark Blue Widow Burst, gloss nitro; blue-matched multi-ply binding	HARDWARE	Gold — TOM bridge, stopbar, Grover Kidney tuners, brass strap buttons
NECK	Mahogany, Custom long neck tenon	ELECTRONICS	2 vol / 2 tone, CTS pots, 3-way toggle, cream switch tip
FINGERBOARD	Ebony, pearl block inlays, split-diamond headstock	WEIGHT ▶	Unconfirmed — comparable Widows run 9 lb 11 oz to 10 lb 0 oz
SCALE / RADIUS	24.75" • 12" • 1.687" Corian nut	CASE / PAPERS	Gibson Custom OHSC, COA, hang tags, warranty card

04 What the market says

Read “listed” (the asking price) and “sold” (what actually changed hands) as two different numbers. For this model the gap is small right now — these hold value unusually well for a modern Gibson because the runs are small and the colour has a cult following.

SOURCE	STATUS	PRICE	NOTES
Guitar Center	LISTED • NEW	\$7,099	“Dark Blue Widow Burst” — current new retail for this exact configuration.
Reverb	SOLD • MINT	\$7,199	2024 LP Custom Figured, trans-blue, mint, sold through a dealer. (Nickel-hardware sibling — same family, same year)
Reverb	LISTED • USED	\$6,500–7,500	Multiple Blue Widow M2M / PSL pieces currently listed by dealers; described as rare & highly desirable.
eBay	SOLD	~\$6,750	Closest clean comp is a 2024 Custom Shop (different model). Blue Widow eBay comps are thin; eBay runs softer than Reverb on high-end Gibsons due to ~13% fees.
Boutique dealers	LISTED	\$6,500–7,500	Eddie’s, Wildwood, Cream City & similar — where these primarily trade.

The catch: those are *dealer / retail* numbers. A private seller does not net retail. After Reverb fees (~5%), shipping, and buyers expecting a discount versus a store with a warranty, a private national sale realistically nets somewhere around \$5,200–\$6,200. Selling locally only, in cash, lands lower again — and that’s where the Denver-specific math comes in below.

05 What you’d get

SELL TO A TRADE SHOP

Dealer / dealer

\$3,800–4,800

CASH OFFER

Shops pay ~50–65% of what they can resell it for. A high-end store that can actually move a Custom Shop piece (e.g. Wildwood in Louisville, or Coal Creek in Englewood, which buys used gear) will sit at the top of that range; a generalist like Guitar Center will lowball a slow-moving blue LP. Expect \$500–\$1,000 more in trade or store credit than in cash.

Instant • same day

LOCAL ONLINE AD - DENVER METRO

Private local

\$4,800–5,500

FACEBOOK / REVERB-LOCAL / CRAIGSLIST

List around \$5,800–\$6,200 to leave room; expect to land in the \$4,800–\$5,500 band with one motivated local buyer. A \$5k+ blue Custom Shop Les Paul is a narrow, high-ticket niche — Denver has the player base, but not many buyers for this guitar at any given moment.

Likely 1–3+ months

NATIONAL LISTING

Reverb (best)

\$5,200–6,200

NET AFTER FEES & SHIPPING

The widest buyer pool and the only place the colour reliably finds its person. The \$7,199 sold comp shows national demand is real. Price it well and it moves in **weeks to ~2 months**; the trade-off is packing, shipping a heavy guitar, and fee/return exposure.

Weeks • ~2 months

BOTTOM LINE

If speed matters, a Denver shop hands you ~\$4,000–\$4,800 today (more in trade). If you want the most money and can wait, list it **nationally on Reverb** and net ~\$5,500–\$6,000. A local-only cash sale splits the difference on price but can sit for months because of the colour and the price point.

06 Helps & hurts

+ Adds value Genuine Nashville Custom Shop — a full tier above Gibson USA; roughly double the resale of a USA Custom. Rare Widow finish with the show-worthy colour-matched binding & headstock inlay — collectible and instantly recognisable. Strong AAA figured top — the flame is dramatic; figure grade directly moves price. Gold hardware & full Custom appointments (ebony board, pearl blocks, multi-ply binding). Complete & correct — OHSC, COA, hang tags, paperwork. Completeness alone is worth several hundred dollars. Near-mint & recent (2024) — modern Custom Shop QC is well regarded.	- Caps value Polarising colour — blue Les Pauls have a far narrower buyer pool than a burst or black. It takes the right buyer, not any buyer. Likely heavy — comparable Widows hit 9.7–10 lb. A 10+ lb weight turns some buyers off; weigh it and disclose. 490R/498T pickups are standard Gibson units, not the Historic-grade Custombuckers purists prize. Modern, not vintage/Historic — these depreciate like normal used gear once sold; they don’t appreciate like a ‘59 reissue. Not individually numbered — “rare” but not a numbered limited edition; several are on the market now, which tempers price. Selling friction — fees (Reverb ~5%, eBay ~13%), shipping a heavy guitar, and any buckle rash / fret wear / finish checking would each chip away.
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07 If you’re unsure — how to verify

Run these checks before you list or sell. Each one either confirms the model or changes the number.

- 01 Custom Shop vs USA.** Back of headstock should read “Gibson Custom” and there must be a COA. A plain “Gibson”-only headstock with no certificate is a USA model worth far less.
- 02 Decode the serial.** Back of headstock. CS + year-digit + number = Custom Shop. Confirms the build year (here, 2024).
- 03 Confirm it’s a Widow.** Colour-matched binding and a coloured split-diamond headstock inlay — collectible and instantly recognisable.
- 04 Hardware colour.** Gold is the premium Widow spec. Nickel “hand-selected top” versions also exist and can price slightly differently.
- 05 Identify the pickups.** Pop a pickup ring or check the cavity. 490R/498T = standard. Custombuckers add desirability; EMG activates narrow the buyer pool. This genuinely moves price.
- 06 Weigh it.** Put the number in any listing. Under ~9.5 lb helps; 10 lb+ hurts and should be disclosed up front.
- 07 Grade the top.** Stronger, more 3-D flame = more money. Photograph it in raking light to show the figure.
- 08 Inspect the headstock & neck.** The Achilles heel of Gibsons. Any headstock crack or repair is a major value hit — check the rear (Plate 05) under good light.

FEATURE	VALUE IMPACT (QUICK REFERENCE)	WHY IT MATTERS
Custom Shop vs USA	▲ Major	The single biggest lever — Custom Shop roughly doubles a comparable USA Custom.
Widow matched binding	▲ Helps	Collectible & distinctive — but ties value to the niche colour market.
Gold hardware	▲ Helps	Premium appointment; expected on the top-spec Widow.
Custombucker pickups	▲ Helps	Historic-grade pickups raise desirability vs 490R/498T.
EMG active pickups	▼ Narrows	Great for metal, but shrinks the traditional-buyer pool.
Weight 10 lb+	▼ Hurts	Comfort matters; heavy examples are a harder sell.
Blue / non-standard colour	▼ Narrows	Fewer buyers than a ‘burst/black; slower sale, occasional premium from the right one.
Missing COA or case	▼ Hurts	Drops a Custom Shop piece several hundred dollars; completeness is prized.
Headstock / neck repair	▼ Major	The biggest single deduction on any Gibson.
Top figure grade	± Swings	Stronger AAA flame > plain top; varies piece to piece.